

# Barnabas Fund Australia: Gifts Procedure

## OVER-RIDING PRINCIPLE:

Barnabas Fund Australia (BFA) is committed to observing the highest standards of integrity in its operations and ensuring that all aspects of its operations are carried out in a thoroughly ethical manner.

Pending the BFA Board formally adopting a Gifts Policy, this Procedure is intended to be followed operationally by all staff and volunteers, as well as by all/any others acting on behalf of BFA.

## OBJECTIVES:

The objectives of this Procedure are to ensure that all persons covered by this Procedure do not accept personal gifts, rewards or other benefits that could be perceived as amounting to a bribe or as a conflict of interest; and to prevent situations where gifts or benefits could be used to influence the actions, decisions, or behaviour of persons representing – or otherwise acting on behalf of – BFA.

## DIRECTIONS:

Persons covered by this Procedure must not:

1. Accept or offer any bribe, whether directly or indirectly, to influence any of BFA's decisions or actions – or of any of the decisions or actions of the person concerned;
2. Accept gifts or benefits from beneficiaries, partners, suppliers, churches, supporters or others in circumstances where such gift or benefit could create a conflict of interest or influence their work, or could be perceived or alleged to do so; or
3. Use their role or position within BFA for personal gain or allow their decisions to be influenced by the offer of gifts, rewards or personal benefits.

## REPORTING AND HANDLING OF GIFTS AND BENEFITS:

### ***Money/Cash Gifts:***

**All** gifts of money (including speaker's fee or amounts expressed to be on account of travelling and/or accommodation costs) **must be** received by the relevant person on trust for BFA and must be reported in post-event reports (if relevant) and must be promptly transferred to the BFA Office or banked into the BFA Bank Account as funds having been received at that event or from that church, supporter or other person/entity.

### ***Explanation:***

The above requirement exists even where the person/entity giving the gift specifically indicates that this is intended as a personal gift. The appropriate response would be to express thanks for the generosity and to affirm that the funds will be accepted on behalf of BFA on the basis that BFA will pay (or has paid) all expenses so that this gift will help reduce that financial burden on the charity.

***Non-monetary gifts:***

It is not uncommon for gifts of a personal nature to be offered, and it is frequently culturally inappropriate to refuse such gifts.

**All** non-monetary gifts, rewards or other benefits received **must be** promptly reported to BFA's Administration Manager to be included in the BFA Gifts Register.

If the gift is of a modest or symbolic nature and of (at best) limited commercial value, the person who received the gift may retain the gift provided:

- a) the gift was given and received merely as a gratuitous act of kindness or appreciation; and
- b) it was neither given nor received on the basis of an expectation of favour or influence.

If the gift has real commercial value, it is to be regarded in the same manner as monetary gifts so that, in addition to reporting the gift to the Administration Manager, the gift must be physically provided/surrendered to the Administration Manager.

The Administration Manager will consult with BFA's National Director and will then:

- a) Arrange for the gift to be sold and the proceeds of sale recorded in BFA's records as a donation; or
- b) If it is suspected that the gift was intended as a bribe or as a way of currying favour or influence, arrange for the gift to be returned to the giver.

In all cases of non-monetary gifts, the Gifts Register will record what action was taken; that is, whether retained by the recipient, returned to the giver, or sold.

**GIFTS REGISTER:**

For the sake of transparency and accountability, the Gifts Register will be regularly reported to meetings of the BFA Board.

**NOTES:*****Modest or Symbolic gifts:***

These may include token gifts such as a small souvenir, a gift of food, a handmade item, or some traditional gift.

***Travel/Accommodation:***

Although not a frequent occurrence, it is occasionally the case that churches or individual supporters offer to pay up-front for travel and/or accommodation, or make an offer of accommodation in their home. Such actions are usually reflective of a strong connection with the work of BFA, and should be treated as such. Where such offers result in cash/money being supplied to the BFA representative, it must be dealt with in accordance with the Money/Cash provisions of this Procedure. Where the generosity relates to accommodation (either in a home or paid direct to a Hotel/Motel), that should be reported as a non-monetary gift.

***Additional Cultural Considerations:***

Although it can frequently be culturally inappropriate to refuse gifts, particularly in the context of social or professional relationships, consideration should ***always*** be given to the potential for such gifts to be seen as acts of bribery, or as being offered and received in exchange for favours or influence. Where the person offered gifts in such circumstances feels unable to refuse the gift, the suspicion *must* be included in the report to BFA's Administration Manager.

***Consequences for violating this Procedure:***

Violations of this Procedure may be subject to disciplinary action, including but not limited to:

- Written warnings or formal reprimands;
- Suspension or termination of employment or engagement; and/or
- Legal action.

This Procedure is enacted by the authority of:

Ashley Saunders

Managing Director, BFA

23 December 2025

I \_\_\_\_\_ acknowledge having received and read this Procedure, and undertake to comply with its provisions.

Signed:

Date: